

James Watt

The inventor whose engine
STEAMED ahead

James Watt didn't invent the steam engine, but his changes made it cheaper to run. His engines powered the Industrial Revolution and changed the world forever.

Hot talent

The first commercially successful **steam engine** was built in 1712 by the English inventor Thomas Newcomen as a way to pump water. Watt noticed that these engines wasted a lot of fuel because the cylinder had to be repeatedly heated and cooled, which required **A LOT OF ENERGY**. In 1769, Watt designed a new engine where the cylinder **stayed hot**—it was far more efficient, using just a quarter of the fuel of the old design.

Young engineer

James Watt was born in Greenock, Scotland, in 1736. The son of a wealthy ship-builder, Watt started off building and repairing mathematical instruments at the University of Glasgow, but quickly took an interest in steam engines.



He paved the way for...

Watt's engine was improved by English engineer **RICHARD TREVITHICK** (1771–1833) who used it to build the first **STEAM TRAIN** in 1804.



In 1829, English inventor **GEORGE STEPHENSON** (1741–1848) built the most advanced train of its day, the **ROCKET**, and the first public train line.

By the way... the watt, a unit of measurement of electrical and mechanical power, is named in my honor.

